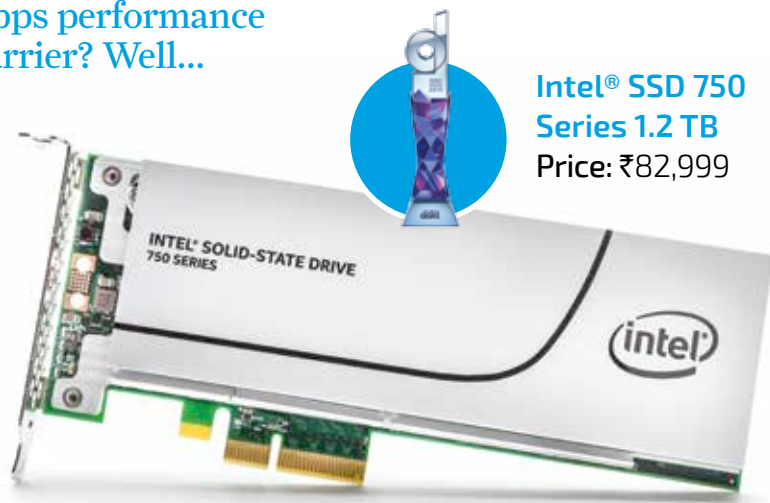


Solid State Drives

How does it feel to break through the 6 Gbps performance barrier? Well...



Intel® SSD 750 Series 1.2 TB
Price: ₹82,999

The NVMe standard's popularity this year has ensured solid state drive speeds to immediately burst through with the latest drives boasting of more than 2,000 MB/s transfer speed. Unfortunately, these drives haven't started selling in India. Apart from the jaw-dropping transfer speeds, these drives are also smaller with most of them having adopted the M.2 standard. Also, the fact that small form factor computers, laptops and current gen motherboards all come with M.2 slots have created a huge demand for these drives.

Zero1 Winner

Intel® SSD 750 Series 1.2 TB

Intel made a huge comeback with the 750 series after their time in the shadows. When SSDs hit the consumer market for the first time, it was Intel which was the shining beacon with its X-25 series and later the 120 and 520 series. And now with NVMe, it has once again come to the forefront with the 750 series, with the 1.2 TB variant priced at ₹82,999.

But it's not as if that isn't appropriate, for the money you get four PCIe 3.0 lanes that push upwards of 2300 MBps. We've managed to eke out around 2331 MBps for sequential data transfers and about 100

MBps when looking at 4K sized files. This makes the 750 series an all round better performer than the competition, thereby winning the Zero1 Awards for SSDs.

Runner-ups

Kingston HyperX Predator and Samsung 850 Pro

We'd say that the pivotal reason these drives ended up being the runner-ups is that they're non NVMe. The Kingston HyperX Predator is a ridiculously fast PCIe SSD which uses the M.2 standard and makes use of all four PCIe lanes. The only thing holding it back is that the AHCI protocol is simply not designed for SSDs. The 480 GB SKU of the HyperX Predator which we had the pleasure of testing uses 1.4 W of power which is but a drop in the ocean when you look at an enthusiast rig of which they're likely to be a part of. Also, Marvell's 88SS9293 controller is about two years old so you've stretched it as much as one could have. How much you ask? 1400 MBps worth. And it's not just the speed with the HyperX Predator SSD, the board has a minimalistic design with a matte black PCB to soothe the multitude of fanatics who croon at the sight of it. Samsung's SSDs have been hogging the limelight for quite some time and here is



Kingston HyperX Predator
Price: ₹48,000



Samsung 850 Pro
Price: ₹10,649



Transcend SSD370S 256 GB
Price: ₹6,849



yet another year where it'll continue to do so. After all it's the best 2.5-inch form factor SSD you can buy. Like the HyperX Predator, it too uses AHCI and was the first consumer SSD to use Samsung's 3D V-NAND technology. The increased density and improved MEX controller give the Samsung 850 Pro a significant advantage.

Best Buy

Transcend SSD370S 256 GB

At the end of the day storage is all about capacity/Rupee and Transcend's SSD370S more than delivers on that front. Being economical does mean that there will be certain areas where performance might be lacking and rightly so the SSD370S has low write speeds but at 290 MBps, they are more than double of what you'd get from mainstream hard drives so you're still getting your money's worth. Recommended for low-cost speed upgrade to your PC.